14.6.4 Close the feedback loop

Policy governance is both proactive and reactive. Incident reports, audit findings, and access review results should feed back into the policy lifecycle. Establish a routine for reviewing incidents where access control was a factor, linking them to ADRs and updating policies as needed. This feedback loop helps prevent recurring problems and shows continuous improvement to regulators and stakeholders.

14.6.5 Align with identity governance

Policy governance and Identity Governance and Administration (IGA) support each other. IGA supplies authoritative identity and entitlement data, while policy governance guarantees these data are properly interpreted during runtime. Synchronizing review cycles and sharing audit results between the IGA and policy governance teams creates a closed loop, strengthening identity integrity and assurance of authorization.

14.6.6 Measure and iterate

Governance maturity can be quantified. Track metrics such as policy review frequency, the number of open audit findings, and the time it takes to resolve policy-related incidents. Use these indicators to identify gaps, prioritize improvements, and show progress over time. Governance, like authorization itself, improves through iteration.

When governance becomes routine, authorization shifts from a set of controls to a lasting capability, an operational discipline that consistently reflects institutional will in every decision the system makes.